- **Objective**:
    - This playbook outlines how to investigate and respond to suspected malicious PowerShell activity on a Windows computer. It covers analysis, containment, eradication, and recovery. This is a simulated exercise based on the previous Wireshark lab; all response actions are hypothetical.
- **Incident scenario:**
    - The Windows computer DESKTOP-L8C5GSJ (10.1.17.215), associated with user shutchenson, received VBScript designed to launch hidden PowerShell and download another script from 5.252.153.241. The capture also shows delivery of obfuscated PowerShell and repeated HTTP requests to that server. Script execution and successful command-and-control communication remain unconfirmed.
- **Roles and responsibilities:**
    - For this solo tabletop, I will simulate each role.
    - *SOC analyst:* Investigates alerts, gathers evidence, and records findings.
    - *Incident lead:* Coordinates the response and approves major decisions.
    - *IT administrator:* Isolates the computer, removes threats, and restores it.
    - *Business owner:* Explains business impact and helps approve its return to service.
- **Detection and analysis:**
    - Open an incident record with the alert time, host, user, and observed indicators.
    - Preserve the PCAP and available endpoint logs; record collection times and evidence locations.
    - Review PowerShell, process creation, and security logs for script execution and parent processes.
    - Check for persistence, suspicious sign-ins, and similar activity on other computers.
    - Separate confirmed findings from assumptions. Escalate to the incident lead based on evidence and potential impact.
- **Containment**:
    - Have the incident lead authorize isolation of the affected computer through endpoint security tools or network controls.
    - Preserve available evidence promptly; avoid restarting or wiping the computer during initial containment.
    - Block traffic to 5.252.153.241 and investigate authenticatoor[.]org for potential blocking.
    - If account compromise is suspected, restrict the affected account and revoke active sessions.
    - Record each action, its time, owner, and business impact.

- **Eradication:**
    - After preserving evidence, remove confirmed malicious files and persistence mechanisms.
    - Rebuild the computer from a trusted image if its integrity cannot be established.
    - Fix the weaknesses that allowed the incident and apply needed security updates.
    - Reset compromised credentials from a clean device.
    - Check other affected computers and document what was removed or corrected.
- **Recovery**:
    - Verify that malicious files and persistence are removed, security tools are working, and required updates are installed.
    - Test essential applications and restore needed data from verified clean backups.
    - Obtain incident lead and business owner approval before reconnecting the computer.
    - Monitor for recurring suspicious activity and reopen the investigation if it returns.
    - Record recovery results and the time the computer returned to service.
- **Lessons learned:**
    - Review the response timeline, decisions, and delays.
    - Identify gaps in logging, detection, communication, and recovery.
    - Assign each improvement an owner and due date.
    - Update the playbook and test the changes in a future exercise.